

European residency, without having to move.

Why is Portugal's Golden Visa the most popular in Europe?

Because the rules are simple and they ask very little of you. You invest €500,000 in a regulated Portuguese fund, spend around a week a year in the country, and your whole family is included. Buying property no longer qualifies: since 2023, investors place their capital in a regulated fund instead.

€500,000

QUALIFYING INVESTMENT

14 days

MIN. STAY, EVERY 2 YEARS

5 years

TO PERMANENT
RESIDENCY

Family

ENTIRE FAMILY INCLUDED

Returns depend on the fund and are never guaranteed. The investment is at-risk capital.

Who qualifies, and what must the fund be?

Five conditions decide whether an investment qualifies at all. This is where most rejected applications go wrong, long before the file reaches the authorities.

A CMVM-registered fund	The fund must be regulated and registered with the CMVM, the Portuguese market regulator.
Real capital at risk	A true investment. Products that guarantee your capital or a fixed return do not qualify.
60% invested in Portugal	At least 60% of the fund must be invested in Portuguese companies or assets.
No property inside the fund	The fund cannot invest directly in property.
What you must show	A clean criminal record, a valid passport, and proof that the money you invest was earned legally.

THE PROCESS

What are the five stages?

- 01 Advice and choice of fund**
We help you choose a qualifying fund that fits your goals and your appetite for risk, and introduce you to the fund managers.
- 02 Set-up and subscription**
You obtain a Portuguese tax number and a bank account, then subscribe to the fund.
- 03 Application**
Your application is submitted to the authorities with all the supporting documents.
- 04 Biometrics and residence card**
Once you are approved, you give your biometrics and receive your residence card. It is renewed every two years.
- 05 Permanent residency and citizenship**
You can apply for permanent residency after five years. Citizenship follows under the nationality law in force at the time.

What does it cost, beyond the investment itself?

The €500,000 you place in a regulated Portuguese fund is the main commitment, and it stays invested for the whole residency period. Everything around it is small by comparison, and we set it out in full before you start.

COST AROUND THE INVESTMENT	WHAT IT COVERS
Legal and application fees	Preparing and submitting your file, together with regulated partners and law firms.
Government fees	Official application, approval and renewal fees. They are charged per person and at each stage.
Fund entry and checks	Subscription and compliance costs, which change from fund to fund.
Set-up in Portugal	Portuguese tax number, bank account and supporting documents.

At our first meeting we give you a full breakdown, item by item, for your family size and your chosen fund. There are no surprises later.

TIMING AND PRESENCE

How long does it take, and how much time do you spend in Portugal?

Processing takes around 12 to 24 months today, mainly because AIMA, the immigration authority, is working through a backlog. Once you are in the programme, you need very little time in the country: 7 days in the first year, then 14 days in every two-year period.

12–24 mo	7 days	14 days
CURRENT PROCESSING TIME	PRESENCE, FIRST YEAR	PRESENCE, EACH 2 YEARS AFTER

Where do most applications go wrong?

Before they are ever submitted. Choosing the right fund, structuring the investment and running the application is where files fail. We are independent, so our advice is based on what performs for you, not on who pays us a commission.

Independent choice of fund	A short list of qualifying funds matched to your goals and your risk profile, with our reasons written down.
The right structure	Subscription, ownership and tax arranged around your situation before any money moves.
The application file	Prepared and submitted with regulated partners and law firms, then followed all the way to your residence card.
Renewals and the five-year path	We track every renewal date, keep the record of your stays, and prepare the permanent residency application in advance.
Property, if you want it	Golden Visa capital cannot go into property, but many clients buy separately. One relationship covers both.

ABOUT SMITH & ADAMS

Who are we, and how can we help?

The Smith & Adams Group is a Lisbon-based real estate group operating as an owner-operator with an integrated advisory practice, covering the full asset lifecycle from acquisition and renovation to letting, operation, and disposal. With over 10 years in the Portuguese market, 500+ units delivered, and €30M+ in advised investments, it serves international private investors seeking stable euro returns and access to Portugal through pathways like the Golden Visa and D2 Visa. Guided by values of independence, performance discipline, and transparency, the group operates across five practices under one institutional standard, including property management, letting, investment advisory, and the endorsed Hygge House brand.

TALK TO AN ADVISOR

One conversation, no obligation, and an honest answer on whether this route fits you.

Book a call →

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